Daniel Ebanks

Harvard University
Institute for Quantitative Social Science

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Education

California Institute of Technology
Ph.D. Social Sciences (September 2023)
M.S. Social Sciences (June 2020)
Thesis: Unexpected Partisan Unity Among Congressional Leaders and Legislators Using New Latent Variable Estimation Techniques and Frameworks
Dissertation Committee: Jonathan N. Katz (*Chair*), R. Michael Alvarez, Gary King, Bob Sherman

Princeton University (May 2015)
A.B., School of Public and International Affairs
Thesis: European Integration through Political Mobilization: Is it Still Possible?

Academic Experience

Intitute for Quantitative Social Science, Harvard University
Research Associate (September 2025-Present)
Postdoctoral Fellow (September 2023-September 2025)

Professional Experience

Nvidia
PhD Research Intern (May-December 2022)

Federal Reserve, Board of Governors
Senior Research Assistant (October 2016-August 2018)
Research Assistant (June 2015- October 2016)
Student Intern (June-August 2014)

Bureau of Foreign Relations, Senate of the French Republic
Student Intern (June-August 2013)

Peer-Reviewed Articles

Activating Identity and Political Action in the #MeToo Era.
Computational Communication Research, 2026. (with Melina Much, Sara Kangaslahti, Jean Kossaifi, R. Michael Alvarez, Anqi Liu, Anima Anandkumar)
DOI: https://doi.org/10.5117/ccr2026.3.5.much

Partisan Preferences Remain Stable as Decisive Voters Remain Persuadable: Evidence from Five Years of Political Turmoil.
Frontiers in Political Science, 2026. (with R. Michael Alvarez)
DOI: https://doi.org/10.3389/fpos.2026.1954942

Analyzing Political Text at Scale with Online Tensor LDA.
Political Analysis, 2025. (with Sara Kangaslahti, Jean Kossaifi, Anqi Liu, R. Michael Alvarez, Anima Anandkumar)
DOI: https://doi.org/10.1017/pan.2025.10024

Political ideology and views toward solar geoengineering in the United States. *PLOS-Climate, 2025.* (with Beatrice Magistro, Ramit Debnath, Paul O. Wennberg, R. Michael Alvarez)
DOI: https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pclm.0000643

Detecting and measuring social media attacks on American election officials. *Frontiers in Political Science, 2025.* (with Sreemanti Dey, Sarah Hashash, R. Michael Alvarez)
DOI: https://doi.org/10.3389/fpos.2025.1488363

Legislative Communication and Power: Measuring Leadership from Social Media Data. *European Political Science Review, 2024* (with Hao Yan, R. Michael Alvarez, Sanmay Das, Betsy Sinclair)
DOI: 10.1017/S1755773924000146

Identifying American climate change free riders and motivating sustainable behavior. *Scientific Reports, 2024.*
(with Beatrice Magistro, Cecilia Abramson, Ramit Debnath, R. Michael Alvarez)
DOI: https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-024-57042-w

Persuadable voters decided the 2022 midterm: Abortion rights and issues-based frameworks for studying election outcomes. *PLOS-ONE, 2024.*
(with Claudia Kann, Jacob Morrier, R. Michael Alvarez)
DOI: https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0294047

Why don't Americans trust university researchers and why it matters for climate change. *PLOS-Climate, 2023.* (with R. Michael Alvarez, Ramit Debnath)
DOI: https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pclm.0000147

Do fossil fuel firms reframe online climate and sustainability communication? A data-driven analysis. *npj Climate Action, 2023.*
(with Ramit Debnath, Kamiar Mohaddes, Thomas Roulet, R. Michael Alvarez)
DOI: https://doi.org/10.1038/s44168-023-00086-x

Working Papers

Topic Models Estimators Are Statistically Inconsistent and Substantively Misleading: Evidence and Solutions *Working Paper.* (with Sara Kangaslahti)
Paper: https://dannyebanks.com/files/topic_consist.pdf

How American Politics Ensures Electoral Accountability in Congress
Working Paper. (with Jonathan N. Katz, Gary King)
Paper: https://gking.harvard.edu/acc

If a Statistical Model Predicts That Common Events Should Occur Only Once in 10,000 Elections, Maybe it's the Wrong Model
Working Paper. (with Jonathan N. Katz, Gary King)
Paper: https://gking.harvard.edu/10k

Geospatial Metadata Improves Discoverability by Connecting Datasets Across Scientific Disciplines
Working Paper. (with Devika Jain)
Paper: https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.16498

Improving Joint Sentiment-Topic Modeling for Studying Political Text: A Tensor Decomposition Approach. *Working Paper.* (with R.Michael Alvarez, Nick Adams-Cohen)

Ideological Feature Extraction *Working Paper.* (with R.Michael Alvarez, Betsy Sinclair, Joon Park, Bojan Tonguz)

Pre-Registered Studies

How Partisan Mediation Biases Trust in Scientists: Conjoint Evidence and Implications for Climate Change *Working Paper.* (with Ramit Debnath, R. Michael Alvarez) DOI: https://osf.io/8ufdv

Calibration of Polarized Trust in Scientists *Working Paper.* (with Ramit Debnath, R. Michael Alvarez) DOI: https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/WF2SX

Research Interests

American Politics, Political Methodology, Institutions, Congress, Electoral Politics, Natural Language Processing, Latent Variable Models, Scalable Tensor Methods, Machine Learning, Causal Inference, Congressional Elections, Bayesian Statistics, Text-as-data methods, Climate Politics

Other Research Articles

Why publishing referee reports could backfire on public trust. *Nature (Correspondence), 2025.* (with Ramit Debnath, R. Michael Alvarez) DOI: https://doi.org/10.1038/d41586-025-02317-z

Fedwire Funds Service: Payments, Balances, and Available Liquidity *Finance and Economics Discussion Series. 2021.* (Anton Badev, Lauren Clark, Jeffrey Marquardt, David Mills) DOI: https://doi.org/10.17016/FEDS.2021.070

The Network of Large-Value Loans in the U.S. *Working Paper.* (with Anton Badev)

Public Scholarship

ElectIt: 2026 U.S. House and Senate Election Forecast. (with Jonathan N. Katz, Gary King) https://gking.harvard.edu/electit/ About 1.1 million views.

Conferences

- Presenter: MPSA, Paper Session, 2021,2022, 2023, 2024
- Presenter: APSA, Paper Session, 2022, 2023, 2024
- Invited Talk: Political Methodology, Paper Session, 2022, 2025
- Presenter: Political Methodology, Poster Session, 2021, 2023
- Invited Talk: Texas Political Methods Meeting, February 2024
- Invited Talk: UCLA, Biostatistics, April 2022
- Invited Talk: Political Networks, Paper Session, July 2021
- Invited Talk: Political Methodology Europe, Panel Session, March 2021
- Presenter: HOW Series on Payments, Federal Reserve, November 2017
- Invited Talk: Consortium for Data Analytics in Risk, UC Berkeley, November 2016

Awards

Resnick Sustainability Institute Scholar
Research Fellowship in the Alvarez Lab, 2021-2023 ($45,000 per year)
Google Cloud Platform Award for the Alvarez Lab, $50,000, 2021-2023

IST/AWS AI4Science Cloud Credit Programs
Political Polarization and Novel Methods for Large Administrative Data, $5,000, 2022

Divisional Award for Excellence in Teaching; Advanced R
Reserve Bank Operations and Payments Systems, 2015

Teaching

California Institute of Technology
Teaching Assistant, Graduate Advanced Methods, Fall 2022
Teaching Assistant, History of U.S. Budgetary Politics II, Spring 2020, 2021
Teaching Assistant, History of U.S. Budgetary Politics I, Winter 2020, 2021
Teaching Assistant, Political Game Theory, Fall 2019

Federal Reserve, Board of Governors
Co-Instructor, Micro-econometrics via Simulations Summer Course, 2016-2017
Teaching Assistant, Micro-econometrics via Simulations Summer Course, 2015

Languages & Software

English (native), French (advanced)
Proficient in R, Stan, Matlab, Python, Stata, LaTeX, AWS and GCP Cloud Computing, Pytorch, Tensorflow, TensorLy
Familiar with FORTRAN, C++, SQL, SAS, SPSS

Software: TensorLy LDA: https://tensorly.org/tlda/dev/index.html
ElectIt, Election Forecasting Software, *Forthcoming*, with (Jonathan Katz, Gary King, Dominic Skinnion, Allison Xu)

Extracurricular

Graduate Student Council, Director for Humanities and Social Science (2021-2022)
Graduate Student Council, Director for Humanities and Social Science (2020-2021)
Federal Reserve LGBTQA+ ERG, Executive Committee (2017 - 2018)
President, Princeton Running Club (2013-2015)

Professional Memberships

APSA, 2020-Present
Society for Political Methodology, 2020-Present
MPSA 2020-Present

Peer Reviewer

Political Analysis, Journal of Machine Learning Research, Cambridge University Press

References

R. Michael Alvarez, Jonathan N. Katz, Gary King